



GDD 39 Bounce

Feel it, then move through it

The teen resilience game for ages 12-15. It deepens Mind Matters into real failure, board-exam pressure and bouncing back, coping that's real, not a poster, and adds the skill of being there for a struggling friend. Seven mechanics, 31 choice-and-voice moments, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Feel it, then move through it.

Bounce is the teen resilience game. It deepens Mind Matters (g38) for ages 12-15: bouncing back from real failure and setbacks, surviving board-exam pressure with coping that's real rather than a motivational poster, reframing without faking positivity, and, crucially, being there for a friend who's struggling. The register is real and near-peer. New v2 build.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g39 · bounce (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 4 · ages 12-15 · real / near-peer
Thread / topics	C · Feelings & Life Skills · UNESCO 5.6, 5.5
Prerequisite / builds on	g21 (Body Confident) · builds on g38 (Mind Matters)
Gating	Core
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the teen resilience game.

84

scenarios

7

mechanics

17

myth-flips

31

choice & voice

0%

binary taps

Wellbeing-safe by design. No toxic positivity ("just think positive") and no pain-based coping; the game holds that "it's okay to not be okay". Supporting a friend means listening and bringing in a trusted adult, never carrying it alone or keeping a dangerous secret. Persistent distress, or any dark or scary thoughts, route firmly and immediately to a trusted adult, **Tele-MANAS 14416**, or **Childline 1098 / 112**.

Resilience, levelled up.

From the Chapter 4 personas. Where Mind Matters (g38, ages 9-12) builds the foundation, Bounce takes it into the harder teen reality: real failure, board-exam intensity, and looking out for friends.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Veer, 14 (exam pressure; "be a man, don't show weakness")	To bounce back from failure and accept support.	branch + strike-rewrite : reframe; lean on people.
Riya, 15 (perfectionism, rank comparison)	To untie worth from marks and quiet the spiral.	strike-rewrite + reflect : marks aren't worth.
The Counsellor	Clear escalation when a teen or friend is in crisis.	branch + role-play : reach out; route up.
Every teen	To be the steady friend, and know their own limits.	role-play : support a friend safely.

Why this works (the evidence). Resilience is adapting and growing through setbacks (not avoiding them), and it's built, by a growth mindset, reframing failure as learning, small steps with celebrated wins, emotional regulation, and at least one stable caring relationship. Exam and performance pressure is intense for Indian teens, and marks don't decide a person's worth. Supporting a struggling friend means listening (not fixing or dismissing) and bringing in a trusted adult; for persistent distress or dark thoughts, reach a trusted adult, Tele-MANAS 14416, or Childline 1098/112.

Seven moves, led by the choice.

Resilience is practised by responding, so **branch** leads (decide how to bounce, reach out, or support), with **strike-rewrite** reframing setbacks and **role-play** carrying the friend-support and reach-out dialogue. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE TEEN DOES	EMBODIES	N
branch (respond) signature	Chooses how to bounce back, handle pressure, or reach out.	Resilience in action.	19
strike-rewrite	Reframes a setback or busts a resilience myth ("failing = failure").	Cognitive reframing.	17
reflect	Recalls past bounce-backs, real worth, safe people.	Self-efficacy; perspective.	14
sort	Sorts real resilience vs toxic positivity; help vs harm.	Judgement.	13
role-play (voice)	Supports a friend; asks for help; calls a helpline.	Peer support; help-seeking.	12
build	Builds a bounce-back routine, comeback plan, perspective check.	Skills, by hand.	5
match	Pairs a pressure thought to a steadier truth; need to move.	Reframing; fit.	4

31 of 84 moments are branch or role-play. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

The two-test, passed.

Is it fun?

Bounce plays like a real-life comeback simulator: you take a knock, the bombed test, the rejection, the public stumble, and choose how to climb back, reframing the setback, building a comeback plan, and being the friend someone needs. It respects teens by being honest, no "good vibes only", which is exactly why the coping it teaches feels usable rather than preachy.

Is it teaching?

Yes, real resilience: that setbacks aren't permanent, that reframing isn't denial, that bouncing back is a learnable skill powered by people, that marks don't decide worth, and that supporting a friend means listening and routing to help, while knowing when to reach out yourself.

The belief it moves. From "resilient people don't feel bad; just think positive; failing means I'm a failure; my marks are my worth; needing help is weak" → "feel it then move through it; reframe honestly; a setback is a lesson; I'm more than a score; reaching out, for me or a friend, is strength."

Built, not bolted on.

84 researched scenarios across the understand → reframe → tools → pressure → support → reach-out arc, grounded in resilience evidence and handled with care. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
What resilience really is	12	strike-rewrite, sort, reflect	Feel-then-move; not toxic positivity; it's learnable.
Reframe the setback	14	strike-rewrite, branch	Growth mindset, "not yet", failure as data, spotlight.
The bounce-back toolkit	12	build, branch, sort	Feel, small steps, regulate, perspective, self-compassion.
Exam & performance pressure	13	branch, strike-rewrite	Boards, marks aren't worth, many paths, Tele-MANAS.
Being there for a friend	16	role-play, branch, sort	Listen not fix; what to say; spot signs; route to an adult.
When to reach out	17	branch, role-play, reflect	Limits of resilience; dark thoughts; helplines; it's okay.

A friend-support role-play (verbatim), the safety-first line.

hook: "A friend shares something heavy and asks you to tell no one, ever."
 best: "I've got you, but if you're in danger I'll help you get an adult, because I care."
 not: "Okay, I promise I'll never tell anyone."
 relearn: "Don't promise secrecy about safety; caring means helping them get help."

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 39 Bounce — Scenario Library.json](#) (84 records, v2 schema).

What this game flips.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
Resilient people don't feel bad.	Resilience is feeling the hurt and finding a way through.	Resilience concept.
Just think positive and you'll be fine.	Honest coping beats forced positivity; it's okay to not be okay.	Anti-toxic-positivity.
Truly resilient people don't need anyone.	Leaning on caring people is a core source of resilience.	Supportive relationships.
Failing means I'm a failure.	Failing at a thing is an event, not your identity.	Growth mindset.
My marks decide my worth.	Marks measure one exam on one day, not your value.	Exam pressure.
One bad result ruins my future.	One result is one moment; there are many paths forward.	Reframe.
Asking for help means I'm weak.	Reaching out is one of the strongest things you can do.	De-stigmatise.
Reframing means pretending it doesn't hurt.	Reframing holds both: it hurts, and there's a way forward.	Reframe vs denial.

The micro-loop.

1. **Hook.** Lensy: "that knock hurt, what do you do next?".
2. **Play.** Choose a bounce-back move (branch), reframe a setback, or support a friend (role-play), rotated.
3. **It helps.** The resilient choice eases the moment; weaker choices get a gentle, honest redirect, never a buzzer.
4. **The flip.** On a myth, UN strikes it and RE writes the honest truth ("failing = failure" → an event, not your identity).
5. **Route to help.** Heavy distress, friend-in-crisis, or dark thoughts surface a trusted adult and Tele-MANAS 14416 / Childline 1098.
6. **Sticker.** The Bounce badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **comeback chooser** and the **friend-support role-play**. The coping-chooser and toolkit-builder are shared with Mind Matters (g38) and Heart Smart (g41); the safeguarding route is shared with Speak Up (g19).

Honest, warm, safe.

- **Register.** Ages 12-15, real and near-peer; honest about how hard things are, never preachy or "good vibes only".
- **No toxic positivity.** Hard feelings are allowed and named; reframing never means pretending it doesn't hurt.
- **Friend support, done safely.** Teens learn to listen and escalate, never to be a friend's therapist or to keep a dangerous secret; supporter self-care is included.
- **Crisis handled with care.** Dark or scary thoughts (own or a friend's) route immediately to a trusted adult and helpline; the game offers resources, it never quizzes or assesses risk.
- **India-real help.** Tele-MANAS (14416, exam-stress aware) and Childline (1098 / 112) are named as concrete, reachable support.
- **Access.** Audio-first, private, offline; India-grounded (board-exam pressure); pairs with Mind Matters (g38) and Heart Smart (g41).

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. bounce** — node.game === GameDone key === registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema**. type + typed payload; the **branch** comeback-chooser leads, with **role-play** for friend-support and reach-out, and **strike-rewrite** for reframing.
- **Fact-checked content**. Resilience strategies and help-resources (Tele-MANAS 14416, Childline 1098/112) verified against current sources; flag help-resource edits for re-verification.
- **Scorecard-gated**. Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, branch at 23%, 0% binary, 31 autonomy, 17 UN→RE, 4 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run score_gdd.py on any edit.
- **Help-resource hook**. Crisis routing via the shared "get help" component (trusted adult / Tele-MANAS / Childline), single source of truth.
- **Tracked**. sync_master_tracker.py marks g39 v2 PASS in the Master Node Table.
- **Generated path**. Label/order/thread changes flow through the xlsx + gen-path, never hand-edited path.ts.

Safety contracts (never traded for engagement): no toxic positivity; it's okay to not be okay; friend-support = listen + escalate, never sole responsibility; crisis always routes to an adult/helpline; no risk-quizzing; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **Resilience is built, not born.** Because growth mindset, reframing, small steps and emotional regulation are the evidence-based ingredients, the game has teens practise each one, turning "I'm not resilient" into a set of learnable moves.
- **One caring relationship is the strongest factor.** Since at least one stable, caring relationship is a top protective factor, the game both teaches teens to lean on people and to be that person for a friend, safely.
- **Pressure is real, so route it.** Exam pressure is intense and serious in India, so the game untie worth from marks, keeps perspective, and connects heavy distress to real help (Tele-MANAS 14416, which specifically supports student exam stress, and Childline 1098/112).

Sources: teen resilience & growth-mindset evidence (reframing, small steps, supportive relationships); Tele-MANAS (India national mental-health helpline, 14416) and Childline (1098/112). Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 25 games now v2. Next in Chapter 4: Plan It (g22).